

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1974 RECOMMENDATION CONCERNING EDUCATION FOR INTERNATIONAL UNDERSTANDING, CO-OPERATION AND PEACE AND EDUCATION RELATING TO HUMAN RIGHTS AND FUNDAMENTAL FREEDOMS

I. Introduction

A. About the 1974 Recommendation

1. UNESCO's *1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms*¹ (the "1974 Recommendation") aims to promote international education and world peace through understanding, solidarity and cooperation. It was adopted on 19 November 1974 by the General Conference of UNESCO at its 18th session.

2. The *1974 Recommendation* applies to formal, non-formal and informal education and to all levels, from pre-primary to tertiary and adult education and lifelong learning. The General Conference recommended "*that Member States should apply*" the provisions included in the *1974 Recommendation* "*by taking whatever legislative or other steps*" that provide institutional (e.g. policies and legal frameworks) and pedagogical (e.g. curricula, teacher training, educational materials, equipment, and student assessment) support for its implementation, based on the "*objectives*", referred to in paragraph 4 of the *1974 Recommendation*, "*regarded as major guiding principles of education policy*" including: an international dimension and a global perspective on education, cultural diversity, interdependence, communication, rights and responsibilities, international solidarity and cooperation, and problem solving.

3. Today, the principles of the *1974 Recommendation* apply equally well to Education for Sustainable Development (ESD) and to Global Citizenship Education (GCED) and therefore represent a powerful tool for promoting the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and in particular SDG Target 4.7 on the promotion of sustainable development and global citizenship through education, Target 12.8 on access to information on sustainable development and Target 13.3 on climate change education.

4. The General Conference in its 39th session recommended the use of the *1974 Recommendation* reporting process to support the implementation and monitoring of Target 4.7 of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (39 C/Resolution 79). The UNESCO Executive Board at its 209th session approved the use of the current guidelines for both the monitoring of the *1974 Recommendation* and the collection of data needed for the following global SDG indicator for which UNESCO is custodian (209 EX/Decision 18.II):

4.7.1, 12.8.1 and 13.3.1: *The extent to which (i) global citizenship education and (ii) education for sustainable development are mainstreamed in (a) national education policies; (b) curricula; (c) teacher education and (d) student assessment.*

5. Questions marked with an asterisk (*) will be used in the calculation of the respective indicators (Table 1). As approved by the Inter-Agency and Expert Group on the SDG Indicators, the indicators will be calculated for primary and secondary education only.

Table 1 Questions used in the calculation of the global SDG indicator for Targets 4.7, 12.8 and 13.3

Policies	Curricula	Teacher education	Student assessment
A2, A4, A5, E1a	B2, B3, B4, E1b	C2, C3, C4, C5, E1c	D2, D3, E1d

B. Reporting obligations

6. The General Conference, at its 18th session, when adopting the *1974 Recommendation* recommended "*that Member States submit [...] reports concerning the action taken by them in pursuance of this recommendation*". Moreover, in accordance with Article VIII of UNESCO's

¹ http://portal.unesco.org/en/ev.php-URL_ID=13088&URL_DO=DO_TOPIC&URL_SECTION=201.html

Constitution “*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization [...] reports [...] on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4.*”

7. Thus, **all UNESCO Member States are expected to report on the steps they have taken to implement the 1974 Recommendation** preferably by completing the following questionnaire. Such reporting takes place every four years.

II. Guidelines for completion of the questionnaire

8. This questionnaire and its accompanying guidelines are addressed to Ministers responsible for relations with UNESCO. The questionnaire is typically completed by Ministries of Education and other government authorities responsible for education. Responses should cover, as far as possible, education at all levels of government, including sub-national levels where applicable as well as education outside the government sector.

9. National respondents are encouraged to **consult widely** both within, across and beyond government, including with Ministries of Environment, with national human rights institutions, the education sector, civil society partners and others, as necessary, to gather the information needed to complete the questionnaire.

10. Responses to the seventh consultation should cover:

- (i) the time period 2017-2020;
- (ii) education at all levels of formal education from pre-primary to tertiary education as well as non-formal education;
- (iii) all levels of government that have responsibility for education within the country; and
- (iv) where possible, education outside the government sector.

11. To assist countries in responding to this questionnaire, UNESCO has developed the following set of global citizenship education and education for sustainable development themes. The list is based on a review of current common practices in many countries as well as a review of relevant literature. While the terms ESD and GCED may be used differently in some countries, the list of themes typically captures what are seen as key elements of Target 4.7. Please refer to the definitions of key terms in **Section III** before completing the questionnaire.

Global citizenship education and education for sustainable development

- 1. cultural diversity and tolerance
 - 1.1 international or intercultural understanding, solidarity and cooperation
 - 1.2 intercultural and interreligious dialogue
 - 1.3 local, national and/or global citizenship
- 2. gender equality education
 - 2.1 gender-based equal opportunities
 - 2.2 gender equality and justice
 - 2.3 gender roles, identity and stereotypes
- 3. human rights education
 - 3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status
 - 3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation
 - 3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)
- 4. peace and non-violence
 - 4.1 friendly relations among peoples and nations

- 4.2 challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together, including others and preventing violent extremism
 - 4.3 preventing all forms of violence including bullying, verbal abuse and gender-based violence
- 5. climate change education
 - 5.1 mitigation
 - 5.2 adaptation
 - 5.3 impact reduction
 - 5.4 early warning
- 6. environmental sustainability
 - 6.1 caring for the planet, protecting nature
 - 6.2 environmental justice
 - 6.3 biodiversity, water
- 7. human survival and well-being
 - 7.1 environmental health as it pertains to human well-being, disaster risk reduction
 - 7.2 health of the planet for future generations
 - 7.3 sustainable cities and communities
- 8. sustainable consumption and production
 - 8.1 responsible and sustainable lifestyles
 - 8.2 green economy, green jobs
 - 8.3 sustainable energy

III. Definitions of key terms

Term	Definition
Themes of global citizenship and education for sustainable development	
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	<i>Education about and for diversity including language, ethnicity, race, religion as well as the development of tolerance, mutual respect and appreciation for cultural diversity. It includes intercultural and interreligious dialogue, understanding, solidarity and co-operation, and citizenship education.</i>
2. Gender equality education	<i>Education that addresses the wider issue of gender equality by promoting new attitudes and patterns of belief, transforming the way people think about traditional gender roles and helping to build long-term sustainable change. It examines how gender roles, activities, needs, opportunities, rights and entitlements affect men, women, girls and boys differently. It deals with the relationships between females and males, their access to and control of resources and the constraints they face relative to each other. It respects the rights of all learners – women, men, boys and girls – equally and gives equal access to learning opportunities, resources and protections. All learners benefit from and are treated in education equally without the limitations set by stereotypes, rigid gender roles and prejudices. It covers gender-based equal opportunities, gender equality and justice, and gender roles, identity and stereotypes.</i>
3. Human rights education	<i>Education that promotes universal respect for and observance of all human rights and fundamental freedoms and thus contributes, inter alia, to the prevention of human rights violations and abuses by providing persons with knowledge, skills and understanding and developing their attitudes and behaviours, to empower them to contribute to the building and promotion of a universal culture of human rights.</i> <i>It includes equality and non-discrimination, human rights values, dignity, justice, inclusion and participation and respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms.</i>
4. Peace and non-violence	<i>Education about peace and peace-building, mediation, conflict prevention and resolution, non-violence, reconciliation and living together peacefully. It includes advocating for friendly relations among peoples and nations, challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together and preventing violent extremism and other forms of violence including bullying.</i>
5. Climate change education	<i>Education to help people, in particular youth, understand, address, mitigate, and adapt to the impacts of climate change. It encourages changes in attitudes and behaviours needed to put the world on a more sustainable development path, and build a new generation of climate change-aware citizens.</i> <i>It covers various responses to climate change including mitigation, adaptation, impact reduction and early warning.</i>
6. Environmental sustainability	<i>Education about responsible interactions with the environment to avoid depletion or degradation and to promote environmental quality and health. It includes, caring for the planet and protecting nature, environmental justice, biodiversity and water.</i>
7. Human survival and well-being	<i>Education that promotes social well-being and harmony including in future generations due to healthy environmental systems. It includes health of the planet and environment related to human well-being, disaster risk reduction and sustainable cities and communities.</i>
8. Sustainable consumption and production	<i>Education on the use and production of resources, products and services that have a minimal adverse impact on the environment. It promotes resource and energy efficiency, sustainable infrastructure and green jobs.</i>

	<i>It includes responsible and sustainable lifestyles, the green economy and sustainable energy.</i>
Dimensions of learning	
Knowledge	<i>Factual information and understanding acquired through study and/or experience.</i>
Skills	<i>The ability to carry out a task well as a result of training, practice and innate aptitude. Skills may be physical, mental or both.</i>
Values	<i>Principles that form the foundation on which individuals conduct themselves and interact with others and with the environment around them.</i>
Attitudes and behaviours	<i>Ability to act on the basis of beliefs and knowledge acquired through study or experience.</i>
Levels of education	
Pre-primary	<i>Education designed to support children's early cognitive, physical, social and emotional development and introduce young children to organized instruction outside of the family context. Participants are usually aged from three years.</i>
Primary and secondary	<i>Education designed to:</i> <i>(i) provide students with fundamental skills in reading, writing and mathematics (i.e. literacy and numeracy) and establish a solid foundation for learning and understanding core areas of knowledge and personal development (primary education); and</i> <i>(ii) prepare students for further education at post-secondary and tertiary levels and for entry into the labour market (secondary education).</i> <i>It includes both general and vocational education.</i>
Tertiary	<i>Education designed to provide learning activities in specialised fields of education. It aims at learning at a high level of complexity and specialisation. It includes both what is commonly understood as academic education and advanced vocational or professional education.</i>
Types of education	
Adult education	<i>Education specifically targeted at individuals who are regarded as adults by their society to improve their technical or professional qualifications, further develop their abilities, enrich their knowledge with the purpose to complete a level of formal education, or to acquire, refresh or update their knowledge, skills and competencies in a particular field.</i>
Formal education	<i>Education that is institutionalized, intentional and planned through public organizations and recognized private bodies which – in their totality – constitute the formal education system of a country. Formal education programmes are recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities. Formal education consists mostly of initial education (e.g., pre-primary, primary, secondary and tertiary education).</i>
Non-formal education	<i>Education that is an addition, alternative and/or a complement to formal education within the process of the lifelong learning of individuals. It is often provided to guarantee the right of access to education for all. It caters to people of all ages but does not necessarily apply a continuous pathway-structure. It may be short in duration and/or low-intensity, and it is typically provided in the form of short courses, workshops or seminars. Non-formal education mostly leads to qualifications that are not recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities or to no qualifications at all. Non-formal education includes programmes on life skills including literacy and numeracy, work skills, and social or cultural development. Most types of adult education are also included.</i>

Vocational education	<i>Education that is designed for learners to acquire the knowledge, skills and competencies specific to a particular occupation or trade or class of occupations or trades. Vocational education may have work-based components (e.g. apprenticeships). Successful completion of such programmes leads to labour-market relevant vocational qualifications acknowledged as occupationally-oriented by the relevant national authorities and/or the labour market. Vocational education can be offered at secondary and post-secondary or tertiary levels of education.</i>
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IV. Information about the respondent

Country:

Finland

Organization:

Ministry of Education and Culture, Secretariat for International Relations

Date of submission:

23 December 2020

V. Other contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire

Please indicate below the names of other organizations and contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire.

Government institutions including other Ministries (please specify):

Ministry for Foreign Affairs, Ministry for Justice, Ministry of Environment, Finnish National Agency for Education (EDUFI)

National human rights institutions (please specify):

Local and regional authorities responsible for education (please specify):

Other local and regional authorities (please specify):

Organizations representing education stakeholders (e.g. teachers, students, parents, etc.) (please specify):

Other civil society organizations (please specify):

"Fingo", Finnish civil society's expert organisation on development policy issues

Others (please specify):

UNESCO Chairs in Finland

VI. Questionnaire

A. Laws and policies (preamble and paras 4 and 7 of the 1974 Recommendation)

A1a. Please describe any specific national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal framework(s) in your country that govern the promotion of global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes² are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

The constitution provides a strong basis for equal rights, also in education. Discrimination in education, is fully outlawed in Finland. The **Non-Discrimination Act** (1325/2014) in Finland has a broad approach in defining discrimination, and obligates employers and organizations, including in education, to prepare non-discrimination plans.

One of the basic principles of Finnish education is that all people must have equal access to high-quality education and training. The same educational opportunities should be available to all citizens irrespective of their ethnic origin, age, wealth or where they live. In Finland, the basic rights and liberties, as stipulated by the Constitution of Finland (731/1999), apply also to foreigners residing in Finland. According to chapter 2, section 6 of the Constitution, everyone is equal before the law. No one shall, without an acceptable reason, be treated differently from other persons on the grounds of sex, age, origin, language, religion, conviction, opinion, health, disability or other reason that concerns his or her person.

Act on Early Childhood Education and Care (540/2018): The Act on Early Childhood Education and Care (ECEC) lays down provisions on the right of a child to early childhood education and care, organisation and provision of early childhood education and care, and the data repository for early childhood education and care. According to the act, the objective of ECEC is to promote the comprehensive development and growth, health and wellbeing of a child in an age-appropriate manner, support the prerequisites of learning and educational equality, to implement diverse pedagogical activities based on play, arts and cultural heritage of a child and thus, promote positive experiences of learning. The act also stipulates that the ECEC environment shall be safe, healthy and conducive to learning. Further, the objective of ECEC is to provide every child equal opportunity for ECEC, promote equity and gender equality and provide competences for understanding and valuing cultural heritage, as well as the linguistic, cultural and religious background of others. The objective is to develop the interpersonal skills of a child, including communication skills, and support his/her growth to act ethically, responsibly and sustainably in society, while respecting others.

The act has recently been amended, and it entered into force in August 2020. The amendments reinstated **universal access to full day ECEC** (previously, since 2016, this universal right was limited to 20 hours per week).

Legislation on ECEC: <https://minedu.fi/en/legislation-ecec>

Basic Education Act (628/1998): The Act gives provisions on pre-primary education, on basic education and on morning and afternoon activities. The Act stipulates the purpose of education as “to support pupils' growth into humanity and into ethically responsible membership of society and to provide them with knowledge and skills needed in life”. The Act also stipulates that every pupil has a right to safe learning environment. The education provider shall draw up a plan, in connection with curriculum design, for safeguarding pupils against violence, bullying and harassment, execute the plan and supervise adherence to it and its implementation. A pupil is also entitled to free pupil welfare necessary for participation in education. Pupil welfare means action promoting and maintaining good learning, good mental and physical health and social well-being, and conditions conducive to these. Translation in English: <https://www.finlex.fi/fi/laki/kaannokset/1998/en19980628.pdf>

Key legislation on general education: <https://minedu.fi/en/legislation-general-education>

Government Decree on the National Objectives for Education Referred to in the Basic Education Act and on the Distribution of Lesson Hours (422/2012) contains provisions on the general national objectives for comprehensive school education and on the distribution of lesson

² See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

hours. The national goals of education are laid down in the Basic Education Act and, in greater detail, in the Government Decree.

Section 2 of the Government Decree underlines the educational task of the school. Supporting the pupils' growth as human beings and into ethically responsible members of society is a central goal. Education must also support the pupils' growth into balanced adults with a healthy self-esteem. Pursuant to the Decree, education promotes knowledge and understanding of cultures and ideological, philosophical and religious traditions, including Christian ones, and the heritage of Western humanism. In addition to respecting life, other people and nature, the Decree highlights the inviolability of human dignity, respect for human rights and the democratic values of Finnish society, including equity and equality. General knowledge and ability is also seen to include cooperation and responsibility, promotion of health and well-being, learning good habits and manners, and promotion of sustainable development.

Pursuant to Section 3 of the Government Decree, a key goal of education is laying a foundation on which the pupils can build extensive general knowledge and abilities and broaden their worldview.

Section 4 of the Government Decree contains goals and principles that direct the organisation of education and pupil welfare. All activities must reinforce educational equity and equality and improve the pupils' learning-to-learn skills and capabilities for lifelong learning. The Decree stresses the utilisation of interactive learning environments and learning outside the school as instructional resources. It also underlines the significance of a school culture that promotes growth and learning as well as effective pupil welfare.

General Upper Secondary Education Act (714/2018): The Act includes provisions on the purpose of general upper secondary education, the provision of education, general upper secondary school instruction, application and student admissions to educational institutions, the rights and obligations of students, the completion of the syllabus, student assessment, and a safe study environment. The purpose of General Upper Secondary Education is to promote the growth of students in becoming good, balanced, educated and active members of society and provide them the knowledge, skills and competences needed for employment, hobbies and versatile development of personality. To add, the purpose is to equip students with competences for lifelong learning and continuous development of themselves. Every student has a right to a safe learning environment. The education provider must protect student from bullying, violence and harassment. The Act stipulates that part of the education provider must organize part of studies in collaboration with the higher education institutions. The Act also stipulates that students must have the opportunity to develop his/her international, as well as work-related and entrepreneurial competences.

Key legislation on general education: <https://minedu.fi/en/legislation-general-education>

Vocational Education and Training Act (531/2017): The act stipulates that the purpose of VET is to strengthen and maintain the population's vocational competences, to promote employment, entrepreneurial competences, lifelong learning and professional development. The objective is to support the development of students in becoming good, balanced, educated and active members of society and provide them the knowledge, skills and competences needed for employment, hobbies and versatile development of personality and to equip students with competences for lifelong learning and continuous development of themselves. Every student has a right to a safe learning environment. The education provider must protect student from bullying, violence and harassment.

The National Core Curricula for early childhood education and care, basic education, general upper secondary education and the national qualification requirements in vocational education and training are important national regulations. They are issued by the National Agency for Education as norms, according to which local curricula are prepared. The National Core Curricula, as well as the national qualification requirements are human rights based and sustainable development (ESD) as well as global citizenship education (GCED) are effectively captured in them, in a cross-cutting manner.

Universities and Universities of Applied Sciences are autonomous actors in Finland in order to guarantee the freedom of science, the arts and higher education. Universities are independent legal entities that have the right to make independent decisions on matters related to their internal

administration. According to the **Universities Act** (558/2009), The mission of the universities is to promote independent academic research as well as academic and artistic education, to provide research-based higher education and to educate students to serve their country and humanity at large. In carrying out their mission, the universities shall promote lifelong learning, interact with the surrounding society and promote the social impact of university research findings and artistic activities.

Universities Act (English) : <https://www.finlex.fi/fi/laki/kaannokset/2009/en20090558.pdf>

According to **Liberal Adult Education Act (632/1998)** the purpose of liberal adult education is to provide education and training that supports people's versatile development, cohesion of society, equality, sustainable development, multiculturalism, internationalization and active citizenship based on the principle of lifelong learning.

The purpose of the **Youth Act** (1285/2016) is to 1) promote the social inclusion of young people and provide them with opportunities for exerting an influence and improve their skills and capabilities to function in society; 2) support the growth, independence and sense of community of young people and facilitate the acquisition of knowledge and adoption of skills necessary for this purpose; 3) support young people's free-time pursuits and engagement in civic society; 4) promote non-discrimination and equality among young people and the realisation of their rights; and 5) improve young people's growth and living conditions. The guiding principles for the attainment of these objectives are 1) solidarity, cultural diversity and internationality, 2) sustainable development, healthy lifestyles and respect for life and the environment; and 3) cross-sectoral cooperation.

Youth Act: <https://minedu.fi/en/legislation-youth>

The purpose of the **Act on the Promotion of Sports and Physical Activity** (390/2015) is to facilitate the opportunities of various demographic groups to engage in physical activity, promote performance sports and associated civic activity, bolster the health and wellbeing of the population, and promote the growth and development of children and young people. Equality, equity, multiculturalism, healthy way of life, respect for the environment, and sustainable development are the founding principles.

The Public Libraries Act (1492/2016) lays down provisions on public libraries and their operations as well as on the promotion of these operations at the local, regional and national level. The objectives of the Act are to promote: 1) equal opportunities for everyone to access education and culture; 2) availability and use of information; 3) reading culture and versatile literacy skills; 4) opportunities for lifelong learning and competence development; 5) active citizenship, democracy and freedom of expression. The implementation of these objectives is based on sense of community, pluralism and cultural diversity. Among other, the public libraries are tasked with providing premises for learning, recreational activities, working, and civic activities, and promoting social and cultural dialogue.

The Act (in English): <https://www.finlex.fi/en/laki/kaannokset/2016/en20161492>

Finland's cultural policy comprises the different sectors of arts and culture, museums, cultural heritage, libraries, cultural exports and creative work. Arts and culture are supported by both central and local government. The recently amended **Museum Act** (312/2019) has the objective to strengthen individuals' and communities' understanding and participation in culture, history and environment, to promote the preservation of cultural and natural heritage and arts to the future generations, as well as to promote cultural diversity, civic values, wellbeing, equity and democracy. Among others, museums are tasked to collaborate and interact with schools and promote education.

According to the Prime Minister Sanna Marin's Government Programme (2019), Finland aims to be carbon neutral by 2035. The **Climate Change Act** is being reformed and strengthened to achieve this target. The reform started with extensive public consultations in autumn 2019. The aim was to hear the views of citizens and different stakeholders on how the Climate Change Act should be amended. Among the events was a roundtable of ministers and young people, and a discussion as part of the 'Children take over the Government' event on climate change mitigation through legislative means. Besides these consultations, towards the end of 2019 the Ministry

conducted small-scale social media surveys on the reform of the Climate Change Act, and a more extensive online survey that brought about 2,500 responses. In early 2020 several public events related to the reform were organised in different parts of Finland. Among the particular target groups were young people and the indigenous Sámi people. Climate change poses a risk to the realisation of fundamental and human rights. This is why perspectives relating to the status of fundamental and human rights are a key priority in the reform of the Climate Change Act. The rights linked to the Climate Change Act include the right to a healthy environment, right to participate and right to security.

Reform: https://valtioneuvosto.fi/-/1410903/ilmastolain-uudistus-on-kaynnissa-kansalaisten-nakemyksia-osallistumisesta-ja-oikeudenmukaisuudesta-kerataan-verkkokyselyilla?languageId=en_US

A1b. Please provide the full names of any laws, legislation or legal frameworks referred to in A1a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

See our reply above

*A2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal frameworks on education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	National				Sub-national			
	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	0	1	99	99	99	99
2. Gender equality	1	1	0	1	99	99	99	99
3. Human rights	1	1	0	0	99	99	99	99
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	0	1	99	99	99	99
5. Climate change	1	1	0	0	99	99	99	99
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	0	0	99	99	99	99
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	0	0	99	99	99	99
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	0	0	99	99	99	99

A3a. Please describe any specific current national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives in your country that promote global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes³ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

In Finland, there is no national strategy specifically devoted to ESD or GCED. However, the promotion of sustainable development/ 2030 Agenda is present – either explicitly or implicitly – in relevant policies related to ESD and GCED.

The objective of **Prime Minister Sanna Marin's Government Programme** (2019) "An inclusive and competent Finland" is to make Finland a society based on socially, economically and ecologically sustainable development by 2030. According to the Government Programme, Finland assumes global responsibility and works actively as a pioneer in achieving the goals of the 2030 Agenda. <https://valtioneuvosto.fi/en/rinne/government-programme>

The **Government Report on the Implementation of the 2030 Agenda: Towards a carbon-neutral welfare society** was published in December 2020. According to the report (p. 39), education for sustainable development; climate change education; digitalisation, financial literacy and working life skills; and sexual and equality education will be mainstreamed at all levels of education. The Government will enhance democracy and human rights education and inclusivity at schools. (SDG 4.7.) Other positive actions towards the achievement of target 4.7 have also been the 'Climate Responsibility in Education' impact programme implemented by the Finnish National Agency for Education and the allocation for special funding for sustainable development themes in continuing education projects for teachers (application round in 2020). <https://julkaisut.valtioneuvosto.fi/handle/10024/162575>

In July 2020 Finland submitted **voluntary national review on the implementation of the UN Agenda 2030 for Sustainable Development**. The report states – among other – that universal social security and service systems, as well as good educational opportunities for the entire population, have prevented exclusion. Persons belonging to visible minorities and persons with disabilities continue to experience discrimination in different areas of life. National legislation and policy actions promoting equality and preventing exclusion aim to ensure equal opportunities for all. <https://julkaisut.valtioneuvosto.fi/handle/10024/162268>

The Ministry of Education and Culture participates in the national implementation of the 2030 Agenda through the **Finnish National Commission on Sustainable Development and the Development Policy Committee**. It also participates in the preparation of Finland's national road map aimed at achieving the goals of the 2030 Agenda, the preparation of which is currently ongoing under the leadership of the Prime Minister's Office.

The Ministry of Education and Culture has in its **Strategy 2030** promised to strengthen its international impact and global responsibility and to commit to sustainable development. Ministry of Education and Culture Strategy 2030 (2019), <https://minedu.fi/en/Publication?pubid=URN:ISBN:978-952-263-632-4>

Additionally, the Ministry of Education and Culture (MoEC) has published a **sustainable development policy in 2020**, with an aim to ensure that the activities of the administrative branch (early childhood education and care, education, science, art, culture, sports and youth work) are based on a sustainable foundation. The preparation was preceded by an open consultation process. The implementation covers all steering methods of the Ministry, namely legislation, financial steering and information steering. The policy supports and for its part complements the implementation of Finland's national 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. Sustainable development policy of the Ministry of Education and Culture and its administrative branch (2020): <https://minedu.fi/en/-/ministerio-linjasi-kestavan-kehityksen-tavoitteet-omalle-hallinnonalalle>

The Government has prepared a draft **report on education policy**. The report sets out a vision for education and research extending to the 2040s. It outlines the changes in resources, structures

³ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

and guidance that will be needed to respond and to influence the factors changing the national and international operating environment, and to create the conditions for a meaningful life for everyone. The report provides an overview of the current situation in education and research and the target state and necessary measures to reach the target. The draft report has been sent on a broad round of consultations. The report is due to be submitted to Parliament early 2021. An implementation plan will be drawn up for the education policy report. The report acknowledges the central role of the entire knowledge sector for sustainable development and sustainable way of life, starting with early childhood education and care to tertiary level education, research and science.

https://minedu.fi/-/koulutuspoliittinen-selonteko-lausunnoille-tavoitteena-turvata-koulutuksen-saavutettavuus-laatu-ja-tasa-arvo?language=en_US

Policy to promote internationalisation in Finnish higher education and research 2017–2025, policy line by the Ministry of Education and Culture, is embedded with the idea that the greatest challenges globally can only be resolved by working together. Finland wishes to be an active participant in the global community, sharing in the responsibilities, offering expertise and helping solve problems. <https://minedu.fi/en/international-strategy-for-higher-education-and-research>

As of 2021 the funding model of higher education institutions consist of a new strategic programme with a global dimension. There are several actions providing collaboration with partner countries on innovative teaching and learning research and education (African countries, India and China) as well as SDGs (with several global partners) and on Food and Health (with China).

Universities Finland (UNIFI) is a co-operational organisation for Finnish universities. In 2020, it published **12 theses on sustainable development and responsibility**. In addition to the universities' basic tasks (research, teaching and societal interaction), these theses cover (campus) activities and the preconditions for the universities' operations more widely. Theses are intended as drivers of the activities especially for the universities themselves. They also challenge universities to operate more sustainably and responsibly. For example, thesis number 1 states « Research activities are aimed at solving great sustainability challenges » and thesis number 4 states : « Studies in sustainable development are part of all degrees and the continuous learning offered. »

<https://www.unifi.fi/viestit/theses-on-sustainable-development-and-responsibility/>

Likewise, **Arene – the Rectors' Conference of Finnish Universities of Applied Sciences** - has approved a **joint programme for sustainable development and responsibility** based on the Agenda 2030. The core of the programme consists of strengthening the ecological handprint of universities of applied sciences and reducing their carbon footprint. These ideas have been depicted as 14 promises and concrete measures that will start at the beginning of 2021. The aim is that each graduate has the ability to promote sustainable development and combat the negative impacts of climate change in society. The aim is that sustainability and responsibility will be taken into account in all RDI activities and they are directed towards producing solutions to sustainability challenges, promoting sustainable development and reducing the impacts of climate change. Also in management and personnel matters, universities of applied sciences promise to act as economically, ecologically, culturally and socially responsible employers. Universities of applied sciences will be carbon neutral by 2030. In order to achieve this, universities of applied sciences systematically commit themselves to taking various measures to reduce emissions, to monitor the development of their carbon footprint and to seek other means of achieving carbon neutrality together. The most significant producers of carbon footprint in universities of applied sciences are related to mobility and travel, properties, food services and procurements.

<http://www.arene.fi/ajankohtaista/universities-of-applied-sciences-sustainable-development-skills-for-everyone/>

According to the Government Program, **democracy, climate action, human rights education and inclusivity will be further enhanced in schools**. In concrete terms, the Ministry of Education and Culture has launched a **“Right to Learn” program**, with a funding of 300 MEUR, extending throughout the government term 2019-2022. The program focuses on early childhood education and care (ECEC) and basic education, aiming at reducing learning disparities in

Finland. The measures also cover aspects of strengthening democracy and human rights education. As part of the program, surveys are made, in order to ensure evidence based decision making. For example, in basic education such surveys will target – among others – the impacts of the current practices on learning in ones' own mother tongue, as well as the preparatory education, which are both highly relevant for pupils with immigrant background.

As part of the Right to Learn Program and the National Democracy Program 2025 (see more below), the Ministry of Education and Culture, together with the Ministry of Justice, have set up a steering group to further develop democracy and human rights education at national level. The steering group will focus on the following themes: 1) Developing measures to put the core curricula into practice, 2) Developing pre-service and in-service teacher training, and 3) Developing cooperation between schools / educational institutions and local communities.

Right to Learn: <https://minedu.fi/en/qualityprogramme>

Wellbeing, safety and the prevention of harassment

In Finland, promoting wellbeing is an important aspect in the school culture. The **multi-professional pupil welfare system** prescribed in legislation (Pupil and Student Welfare Act 1287/2013) is the main mechanism for preventing and intervening in all kinds of harassment from the viewpoint of both the entire school and an individual pupil. Pupil welfare is organized in multidisciplinary cooperation with educational administration and health and social services so that a uniform service is formed. Pupil welfare is implemented in cooperation with the pupil and the pupil's guardian, taking into consideration the pupil's age and capabilities. The primary responsibility for pupil welfare lies with the school's staff. Pupil welfare services include psychologist's and school social worker's services and school health services, to which pupils and students of pre-primary and basic education, general upper secondary education and vocational education and training have a statutory right. The national core curriculum lays down detailed and comprehensive provisions on how pupil welfare should be organized.

In spring 2018, the Ministry of Education and Culture launched the preparation of **a national action plan to improve the safety cultures of the learning communities** in early childhood education and care, pre-primary and basic education, upper secondary education and higher education (2018-2021). The programme sees safety broadly as physical, mental and social safety, thus also taking into account the prevention of harassment and sexual harassment.

All schools and education providers are obliged to prepare a **plan for the promotion of non-discrimination**. This is stipulated by the **Non-Discrimination Act** (1325/2014). The plan must cover all discrimination grounds pursuant to the Non-Discrimination Act, thus age, origin, nationality, language, religion, belief, opinion, political activity, trade union activity, family relationships, state of health, disability, sexual orientation or other personal characteristics.

The Equality Act **obliges all educational institutions to prepare a gender equality plan** to develop their activities. It must contain an assessment of the gender equality situation within the institution, the necessary measures to promote gender equality and a review of the previous plan. Special attention must be given to: pupil and student selections; organisation of teaching; learning differences and the evaluation of study performance; • prevention of sexual harassment and gender-based harassment.

The Finnish National Agency for Education (EDUFI) provides **guidance for teachers, schools and education providers in their equality and non-discrimination planning**. For example, a handbook/guide "Tasa-arvotyö on taitolaji" (*Equality work is a skilled craft*) for basic education (EDUFI, 2015), available in Finnish:

https://www.oph.fi/sites/default/files/documents/173318_tasa_arvotyö_on_taitolaji_0.pdf

This was followed by a guide for upper secondary education in 2019 called "Mukana! Tasa-arvo ja yhdenvertaisuustyö toisella asteella" (On board! Equality and equity work at secondary level), available in Finnish: <https://www.oph.fi/fi/tilastot-ja-julkaisut/julkaisut/mukana-tasa-arvo-ja-yhdenvertaisuustyö-toisella-asteella>

The Ministry of Education and Culture has supported the **Kivakoulu ("Nice school") programme aimed at reducing school bullying**. About 90% of all comprehensive schools in Finland have been registered users of the program and they have reached good results. The University of Turku coordinates and develops the programme (since 2011). The programme has been implemented in other countries, too. <http://www.kivaprogram.net/>

ESD / GCED principles are in many ways taken on board also in other sectors, such as

According to the Youth Act (1285/2016), the Government shall adopt a national youth work and policy programme every four years. In December 2019, the **National youth work and youth policy programme 2020-2023** was adopted by the Government. The programme was prepared in a cross-administrative working group, directed by a Ministerial Group, which included the Minister of Science and Culture as the chair, and Minister of Family Affairs and Social Services, Minister of the Environment and Climate Change, the Minister of Social Affairs and Health, as well as Minister for Nordic Cooperation and Equality as members of the group.

Taking into account the youth policy objectives and measures included in the Government Programme as well as the work carried out within the framework of the Government's other strategies and programmes, the Government has specified three sets of youth policy objectives to be implemented for 2020–2023:

- Young people will have the prerequisites for smoothly running daily lives – Social exclusion will be reduced
- Young people will have the means and skills for participation and exerting influence
- Young people will have trust in society – Non-discrimination and security will be strengthened

The aim of the programme is to improve the conditions young people live and grow in, thereby preventing marginalization and discrimination, and promoting participation. The program emphasizes the need to strengthen education for democracy and human rights education through a school-wide approach, as well as improving the competences of teachers. The programme also aims to ensure that young people's voices will be heard in the climate change debate.

The programme also outlines:

– *The entire educational system and, in particular, the possibilities provided by curricula and qualification requirements, will be used to guarantee each learner of any age up-to-date and justified information on climate change and its impacts. Teachers will be offered in-service training on this topic area.*

– *Education providers will be encouraged to follow the principles of sustainable development and set an example for how educational institutions can take ecological, economic and social sustainability perspectives into account in their continuous operation. Good practices related to sustainable development will be shared nationally.*

Ministry of Education and Culture:

<https://minedu.fi/en/policies-and-development-youth>

Finland's second **National Action Plan on Fundamental and Human Rights** 2017-2019 was approved by a Government resolution on 16 February 2017. The priorities of the Action Plan included fundamental and human rights education and training, equality, the right to self-determination and fundamental rights and digitalisation. The Ministry of the Justice is currently preparing the third National Action Plan for the years 2021-2023 and will also carry out a partial reform of the Non-Discrimination Act.

The Ministry of Justice also coordinates the preparation of the **National Democracy Programme 2025**. Democracy and human rights education and participation of young people is one of the central focuses of the Programme. The Government will ensure that all young people have sufficient skills and knowledge to be able to participate. For example, the aim is to strengthen the implementation of core curricula in schools, in terms of democracy and human rights, to develop democracy and human rights education in teachers' initial and continuing education, to strengthen the awareness of public authorities on children's and young people's participatory rights, to strengthen the equal participation of young people and good relations between population groups,

and to improve recognition and acknowledgment of prior work experience and learning gained from voluntary work.

<https://oikeusministerio.fi/en/national-democracy-programme-2025>

Both processes, the preparation of National Action Plan on Fundamental and Human Rights, as well as the National Democracy Programme are cross-sectoral, thus the branches of the Ministry of Education and Culture are firmly engaged.

The **Guidelines for Civil Society in Development Policy** (2017) are aligned with the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and promote both ESD and GCED. The guidelines emphasise that the participation of Finnish CSOs in development cooperation and humanitarian assistance adds to the Finns' understanding of and competencies in development issues. The organisations' activities in developing countries and the opportunities for participation and volunteering they provide forge contacts between Finns and the citizens of other countries. Successful communication concerning development is instrumental in that the Finns are ready to be actively involved in the promotion of global justice and burden-sharing. Understanding global problems can also reduce xenophobia and the social tensions arising from it in Finland. The Guidelines and SDG target 4.7 guide the Ministry for Foreign Affairs' work and support to Finnish CSO on ESD and GCED.

As part of the implementation of the **Meaningful in Finland Action Plan**, which launched by the Ministry of Education and Culture in 2016 to prevent hate speech and racism in the administrative branch of the Ministry, training on working in a multicultural environment has been organised for persons working with children and young people. This aims at supporting their capacities to strengthen democratic values, awareness of human rights and a sense of inclusion among children and young people.

http://www.minedu.fi/OPM/Julkaisut/2016/toimintaohjelma.html?lang=fi&extra_locale=en

The **national media education policy** was published in 2019 by the Ministry of Education and Culture, updating the previous policy line (2013), in collaboration with the National Audiovisual Institute (KAVI), in cross-administrative and cross-sectoral collaboration with actors involved in media education. High-quality media education aims to promote human rights, equality and non-discrimination and to create preconditions for sustainable development. Media education in Finland is based on the UN Universal Declaration of Human Rights, European Convention on Human Rights (63/1999) and, as far as it is applicable to children, particularly on the Convention on the Rights of the Child. Media literacy contributes to the consolidation of democracy and human rights education. Media education policy: <http://julkaisut.valtioneuvosto.fi/handle/10024/162065>

The national **Action Plan for the Prevention of Violent Radicalisation and Extremism** 2019-2023 was published in December 2019, and prepared in collaboration with authorities (incl. of education), expert organisations and communities. The Ministry of the Interior coordinates the implementation. The aims is – among others – to promote the engagement of young people in the PVE work, eg. through education for democracy in formal education, by putting more focus on youth work online, and combatting discrimination and racism through sport. Action Plan in English, Ministry of the Interior:

https://julkaisut.valtioneuvosto.fi/bitstream/handle/10024/162200/SM_2020_3.pdf

A3b. **Please provide the full names of any education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives referred to in A3a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.**

See our reply above

*A4. Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives affecting each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	9

*A5 Please indicate whether national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives on education provide a mandate to integrate GCED and ESD in the following areas by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
Design or revision of the curricula	1	1	1	1
Setting of programme learning objectives	99	99	99	99
Textbook development	1	1	99	99
Teacher education and training	1	1	1	1
Assessment of student outcomes	1	1	1	99
Sub-national				
Design or revision of the curricula	1	1	1	99
Setting of programme learning objectives	99	99	99	99
Textbook development	99	99	99	99
Teacher education and training	99	99	1	99
Assessment of student outcomes	99	99	99	99

B. Curriculum (paras 4 and 10-19 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

B1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in school curricula. Indicate whether topics are taught as standalone subjects or are integrated into the curricula of other subjects. Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes⁴ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

In Finland, the national core curricula are prepared by the Finnish National Agency for Education, in broad consultation with stakeholders. All school education providers follow the national core curriculum, which includes a general section outlining the value base, concept of learning, operational culture, and assessment, as well as the objectives and core contents of different subjects. The education providers - most often municipalities as the local education authorities - and the schools themselves draw up their own curricula within the framework of the national core curriculum.

In Finland, ESD and GCED are strongly embedded in core curricula, especially in the general section but in varying degrees also in the subject syllabi, at all levels of education.

The core curricula emphasize sustainable development, human rights and human dignity, the appreciation of cultural and linguistic diversity, as well as democratic agency in many ways. They emphasize “**transversal competences**” that need to be taken into account in all subjects, by every teacher. It is understood that competences crossing the boundaries of different fields of knowledge and skills are a precondition for personal growth, studying, work and civic activity now and in the future. These competence areas emphasize the aims of the Agenda 2030 in many ways.

In **basic education** they are as follows:

- 1) Thinking and learning to learn
- 2) Cultural literacy, communication and expression
- 3) Managing daily life, taking care of oneself and others
- 4) Multiliteracy (covers also media and information literacy)
- 5) ICT-skills
- 6) Entrepreneurial and work life skills
- 7) Participation and building sustainable future.

The national core curricula for **pre-primary education**, as well as in basic education were renewed in 2014 (implementation started in 2016). Following the legislative reform of the general upper secondary education, the national core curriculum was renewed in 2019 (implementation starts in 2021).

The transversal competence areas in **general upper secondary education** are:

- 1) well-being competence
- 2) interaction competence
- 3) multidisciplinary and creative competence
- 4) societal competence
- 5) ethics and environmental competence
- 6) global and cultural competence.

In studies of all these areas, the idea is that the students

1. observe and analyze contemporary phenomena and operating environments and learn to seek elements for building a good future
2. are able to express their justified views of desirable changes and are emboldened to work for ethically sustainable solutions at the level of both their daily lives and society
3. are given opportunities for challenging their comfort zone, sharing knowledge and peer learning as well as producing ideas and solutions together.

⁴ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

In **vocational education and training**, sustainable development is one of the key competences included in all vocational qualifications. ESD and GCED have been integrated into the foundations of professional qualifications as competence requirements and skills requirements for each profession.

B1b. Please provide examples of curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

As described above, the ESD and GCED are in many ways embedded in the Finnish national core curricula, at all levels of education. Principles are embedded not only in transversal competence areas, as well as in subject-specific objectives, but also in the underlying values of curricula. In the basic education, such underlying values are for example “the uniqueness of each pupil and right to a good education”, “humanity, general knowledge and ability, equality and democracy”, “cultural diversity as a richness” and “the necessity of a sustainable way of living”.

Some extracts in the core curriculum for basic education :

Underlying values of basic education

The underlying values are defined as follows: 1) Uniqueness of each pupil and right to a good education, 2) Humanity, general knowledge and ability, equality and democracy, 3) Cultural diversity as a richness and 4) Necessity of a sustainable way of living

Basic education is built on respect for life and human rights. It directs the pupils to defend these values and to appreciate the inviolability of human dignity. Basic education promotes well-being, democracy and active agency in civil society.

Humanity, general knowledge and ability, equality and democracy

Basic education supports the pupil's growth as a human being who strives for truth, goodness, beauty, justice and peace. In personal growth, conflicts between aspirations and the current reality unavoidably arise. Being able to address such conflicts ethically and sympathetically and having the courage to stand up for what is good are part of general knowledge and ability. Knowledge and ability also means that individuals and communities are capable of making decisions based on ethical reflection, putting themselves in the place of another person, and consideration based on knowledge.

(...)

General knowledge and ability manifest themselves in our attitudes to ourselves, other people, the environment and information, in the ways we act and in our willingness to take action. Educated persons strive to act correctly and show respect for themselves, other people and the environment. They are able to use information critically.

Cultural diversity as a richness

(Basic education) ...reinforces creativity and respect for cultural diversity and promotes interaction within and between cultures, thus laying a foundation for culturally sustainable development.

(...)

Basic education lays the foundation for global citizenship that respects human rights and encourages the pupils to act for positive change.

Necessity of a sustainable way of living

Humans are part of nature and completely dependent on the vitality of ecosystems. Understanding this plays a key role in growth as a human being. Basic education acknowledges the necessity of sustainable development and ecosocial knowledge and ability, follows their principles and guides the pupils in adopting a sustainable way of living. Sustainable development and ways of living comprise an ecological and economic dimension as well as a social and cultural dimension. The leading idea of ecosocial knowledge and ability is creating ways of living and a culture that foster the inviolability of human dignity and the diversity and ability for renewal of ecosystems while building a competence base for a circular economy underpinned by sustainable

use of natural resources. Ecosocial knowledge and ability means that the pupils understand the seriousness of climate change, in particular, and strive for sustainability.

The way humans develop and use technology and make decisions about technology is based on their values. They have a responsibility to steer technology into a direction that safeguards the future of humans and the environment. In basic education, the pupils examine the conflicting aspects of our modes of consumption and production in terms of a sustainable future, and seek and jointly put to practice solutions that improve our way of living over the long term. The pupils are also familiarised with social structures and solutions that impact on the development and guided in exerting influence on them. Basic education broadens the pupils' horizons, allowing them to appreciate their cross-generational global responsibility.

Mission of basic education

The mission of basic education may be examined from the perspective of its educational task, social task, cultural task or future-related task.

(...)

Education promotes participation, a sustainable way of living and growth as a member of a democratic society. Basic education educates the pupils to know, respect and defend human rights. The social task of basic education is to promote equity, equality and justice.

(...)

The cultural task of basic education is to promote versatile cultural competence and appreciation of the cultural heritage, and to support pupils in building their own cultural identity and cultural capital.

(...)

Changes in the world outside the school unavoidably affect the pupils' development and well-being as well as the operation of the school. In basic education, the pupils learn to encounter pressures for change openly, to assess them critically and to assume responsibility for making choices that build our future. Global education as part of basic education contributes to creating preconditions for fair and sustainable development in line with UN development goals. As far as possible, schools work together with schools and education actors in other countries. Basic education exerts influence as a driver for positive change that contributes to society, both at the national and the international level.

The elements of ESD/ GCED are integrated in the core curriculum in a cross-cutting manner through transversal competence areas, which need to be taken into account in all teaching and learning. They are as follows:

Aiming for transversal competence

Transversal competence refers to an entity consisting of knowledge, skills, values, attitudes and will. Competence also means an ability to apply knowledge and skills in a given situation.

Thinking and learning to learn (T1)

Thinking and learning skills underlie the development of other competences and lifelong learning. The way in which the pupils see themselves as learners and interact with their environment influences their thinking and learning. The way in which they learn to make observations and to seek, evaluate, edit, produce and share information and ideas is also essential.

(...) It is crucial that the teachers encourage their pupils to trust themselves and their views while being open to new solutions.

(...) The pupils are guided to consider things from different viewpoints, to seek new information and to use it as a basis for reviewing the way they think.

(...) A precondition for finding innovative answers is that the pupils learn to see alternatives and combine perspectives open-mindedly and are able to think outside the box. Playing, gameful learning and physical activities, experimental approaches and other functional working approaches and various art forms promote the joy of learning and reinforce capabilities for creative thinking and perception.

Cultural competence, interaction and self-expression (T2)

The pupils are growing up in a world where cultural, linguistic, religious and philosophical diversity is part of life. Preconditions for a culturally sustainable way of living and acting in a diverse environment are possessing cultural competence based on respect for human rights, skills in

appreciative interaction and means for expressing oneself and one's views. Pupils in basic education are guided in recognising and appreciating cultural meanings in their environment and building a personal cultural identity and a positive relationship with the environment.
(...) The pupils are also supported to recognise how cultures, religions and philosophies exert influence in society and daily life and how the media shapes the culture, and also to consider what is unacceptable as a violation of human rights.

Taking care of oneself and managing daily life (T3)

Managing daily life requires an increasingly wide range of skills. This area covers health, safety and human relationships, mobility and transport, acting in the increasingly technological daily life, and managing personal finance and consumption, all of which are elements of a sustainable way of living.

(...) In basic education, pupils have opportunities to practise making choices and acting in a sustainable way

Multiliteracy (T4)

Multiliteracy is the competence to interpret, produce and make a value judgement across a variety of different texts, which will help the pupils to understand diverse modes of cultural communication and to build their personal identity.

(...) The pupils need multiliteracy in order to interpret the world around them and to perceive its cultural diversity. Multiliteracy means abilities to obtain, combine, modify, produce, present and evaluate information in different modes, in different contexts and situations, and by using various tools. Multiliteracy supports the development of critical thinking and learning skills. While developing it, the pupils also discuss and reflect ethical and aesthetic questions. Multiliteracy involves many different literacies that are developed in all teaching and learning.

ICT Competence (T5)

Competence in information and communication technology (ICT) is an important civic skill both in itself and as part of multiliteracy. It is an object and a tool of learning. Basic education ensures that all pupils have possibilities for developing their ICT competence.

(...) Pupils learn to assess the impact of ICT from the perspective of sustainable development and to be responsible consumers. During their years in basic education, the pupils also gather experiences of using ICT in international communication. They learn to perceive its significance, potential and risks in a global world

Working life competence and entrepreneurship (T6)

Working life, occupations and the nature of work are changing as a consequence of such drivers as technological advancement and globalisation of the economy. Anticipating the requirements of work is more difficult than before. Basic education must impart general capabilities that promote interest in and a positive attitude towards work and working life. It is important for the pupils to obtain experiences that help them to understand the importance of work and enterprising, the potential of entrepreneurship and their personal responsibility as members of their community and society.

(...) The pupils are encouraged to grasp new opportunities with an open mind and to act flexibly and creatively when faced with change. They are guided to take initiative and to look for various options. The pupils are supported in identifying their vocational interests and making reasoned choices regarding further studies from their own starting points, conscious of the impacts of traditional gender roles and other role models.

Participation, involvement and building a sustainable future (T7)

Participating in civic activity is a basic precondition for an effective democracy. Skills in participation and involvement as well as a responsible attitude towards the future may only be learned by practising. The school environment offers a safe setting for this, while basic education also lays a foundation of competence for the pupils' growth into active citizens who use their democratic rights and freedoms responsibly. The mission of the school is to reinforce the participation of each pupil.

Basic education creates the bases for the pupils' interest in the school community and society. The school respects their right to participate in decision-making as indicated by their age and level of development. The pupils take part in planning, implementing, assessing and evaluating their

own learning, joint school work and the learning environment. They gather knowledge and experiences of the systems and methods for participation and involvement in civic society and communal work outside the school. The pupils understand the significance of protecting the environment through their personal relationship with nature. They learn to assess the impacts of media and to exploit the potential it offers. By experience, the pupils learn about involvement, decision-making and responsibility. They also learn to understand the significance of rules, agreements and trust. Through participation both at school and outside it, the pupils learn to express their views constructively. They learn to work together and are offered opportunities to practise negotiation skills, arbitration and conflict resolution as well as critical examination of issues. The pupils are encouraged to consider proposals from the perspectives of equality of the different parties, fair treatment and a sustainable way of living.

During their years in basic education, the pupils consider the links between the past, the present and the future and reflect on various alternative futures. They are guided to understand the significance of their choices, way of living and actions not only to themselves but also to their local environment, society and nature. The pupils develop capabilities for evaluating both their own and their community's and society's operating methods and structures and for changing them so that they contribute to a sustainable future.

In many ways, ESD/ GCED are present also on the underlying principles that guide the development of school culture, emphasizing safety, wellbeing, equity and equality, cultural diversity, as well as participation and democratic action.

For example:

Cultural diversity and language awareness

The school as a learning community is part of a culturally transforming and diverse society where the local and the global overlap. Different identities, languages, religions and worldviews coexist and interact. Internationalisation at home is an important resource for a learning community. The community appreciates and draws upon the country's cultural heritage and national languages as well as cultural, linguistic, religious and philosophical diversity in the community itself and in its environment. It brings up the importance of the Sámi culture and various minorities in Finland. It promotes understanding and respect between individuals and groups as well as responsible action. The community recognises the right to one's own language and culture as a fundamental right. The pupils become acquainted with cultural traditions, constructively discuss different ways of thinking and acting, and create new ways of acting together.

Participation and democratic action

A learning community constructs its operating methods together. A school culture that promotes participation, realises human rights and operates democratically lays a foundation for the pupils' growth into active citizens.

(...) Cooperation with various branches of administration, parishes, organisations, companies and other actors expands the pupils' ideas of the society and action in a civic society. Contacts with schools in different countries improve skills in acting in a globalised world.

Equity and equality

A learning community promotes equity and equality. Members of the community are encountered and treated as equals, independently of any personal characteristics. Equality does not mean that everyone is the same. Equal treatment comprises both safeguarding everybody's fundamental rights and opportunities for participation and addressing individual needs.

The pupils' conceptions of their gender identity and sexuality evolve during their time in basic education. A learning community promotes gender equality by its values and practices and supports the pupils in forming their gender identity. The approach of the instruction is characterised by gender-awareness.

Environmental responsibility and sustainable future orientation

A learning community accounts for the necessity of a sustainable way of living in all of its activities. The school demonstrates its responsible attitude towards the environment by its everyday choices and activities. Material choices and operating methods that waste raw materials, energy and biodiversity are replaced by sustainable ones. The role that immaterial factors of a sustainable way of living plays in well-being is highlighted, and time is set aside and visibility is given for these

factors in everyday school work. The pupils are involved in planning and implementing sustainable everyday life.

A learning community inspires hope of a good future by laying a foundation for ecosocial knowledge and ability. A realistic and practical attitude towards shaping the preconditions for a good future reinforces the pupils' growth into responsible community members, municipal residents and citizens. It encourages the pupils to encounter the world's diversity with an open mind and curiosity and to act for a more just and sustainable future.

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In Finland, education is developed in a way that emphasizes the continuum between different levels of education. Thus, the general upper secondary education, as well as vocational education and training build upon basic education.

The national core curriculum for general upper secondary education has been recently updated in line with the **reformed Act on Upper Secondary Education** (714/2018, became effective in August 2019), which - among other things – emphasises the continuum from upper secondary education to higher education. In order to achieve this, more emphasis will be given to personalised counselling, guidance, wellbeing and support. According to the Act, General Upper Secondary schools and education providers are obliged in arranging part of studies in collaboration with Higher Education Institutes, which strengthens the continuum between education levels and encourages to continue studies.

The foundations for ESD/ GCED are set in the central chapters of the General Upper Secondary Core Curriculum, such as:

Mission of general upper secondary education

During the years spent in general upper secondary education, the students build their essential knowledge, competence, and agency related to people, cultures, the environment, and society. General upper secondary education prepares the students to understand the complex interdependencies prevalent in life and the world as well as to analyse extensive phenomena. General upper secondary education guides the students towards drawing up plans for the future, growing into global citizens, and continuous learning.

Underlying values of general upper secondary education

General upper secondary education helps the students understand the necessity for a sustainable way of life and builds a competence base for an economy that promotes the well-being of the environment and citizens. The students understand the significance of their own actions and global responsibility in the sustainable use of natural resources, mitigation of climate change, and preservation of biodiversity. General upper secondary education encourages responsible agency as well as engagement in international cooperation and global citizenship in keeping with the UN's 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development.

Vocational education and training (VET) supports students' development as human beings, members of society and employees for different occupations. Sustainable development is in many ways inserted in the vocational qualification requirements. Vocational education is guided by qualification criteria developed for different fields. The common units of vocational undergraduate degrees ensure a common foundation for all students in general working life skills and general education skills. Sustainable development is one of these common units. In addition, sustainable development is integrated in every qualification requirements as needed in different occupations.

***B2** Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	9
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	9
3. Human rights	1	1	1	9
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	9
5. Climate change	1	1	1	9
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	9
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	9
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	9

***B3** Please indicate in which subjects or fields of study GCED and ESD are taught in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Cultural diversity and tolerance	Gender equality	Human rights	Peace and non-violence	Climate change	Environmental sustainability	Human survival and well-being	Sustainable consumption and production
Arts	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Civics, civil or citizenship education	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Ethics/moral studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Geography	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Health, physical education and sports	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
History	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Languages	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Mathematics	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Religious education	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Science	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Social studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Integrated studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Other (please specify) GCED and ESD are taught in primary and secondary education in every subject as part of the transversal competences. All of the mentioned topics are described in the value base, mission and ethos of primary and secondary Core Curricula, so they direct all schoolwork.								

***B4** Please indicate the approaches used to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	0
Cross-curriculum approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum</i>)	0
Integrated approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum</i>)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school</i>)	9 By establishing a ESD/ GCED oriented ethos the curricula aim at this approach, but it is unknown to what extent this is accomplished in the daily work of our schools. Therefore we will mark 9 (unknown)

B5 Please indicate which human rights education themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
3. Human rights education				
3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status	1	1	1	9
3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation	1	1	1	9
3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)	1	1	1	9

C. Teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) (paras 4 and 33-37 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

C1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in initial training and in continuing professional development of teachers, trainers and educators. Indicate whether all teachers, trainers and educators or only some are required to receive training to teach GCED and/or ESD.

In Finland, teacher education is provided by autonomous universities. Teacher education needs to equip the teachers with the necessary competences for implementing the national core curricula. Therefore, it is fair to say that all teachers receive the basic knowledge and skills, relevant to ESD and GCED during their pre-service education.

The **sustainable development policy** of the Ministry of Education and Culture (2020) stresses the importance of addressing the sustainable development perspectives in teacher education and supports the strengthening of sustainable development in in-service training of teachers.

Although there is no integrated/ systematic approach to ESD/GCED in pre-service teacher education, there is variety of ways in which the themes of ESD and GCED are handled in different universities. For example, the University of Oulu has offered an international five-year **Master's Degree "Intercultural Teacher Education (ITE)" programme**, providing qualification as primary teacher in Finland since 1994 with a focus on cultural diversity, sustainability, ethics, social justice and global issues in education.

<https://studyinfo.fi/app/#!/korkeakoulu/1.2.246.562.17.96846537395>

In 2016, a national **teacher education development programme** (TEDP) was launched by the Ministry of Education and Culture, covering teacher education at all levels. One of the objectives of the TEDP is that Finnish teachers are future-oriented and broad-based experts who create new pedagogical innovations and utilize new learning environments and digital tools. They should be constantly developing their own competence and contribute to the collaborative development of the entire learning community. The TEDP program was prepared in broad co-operation with virtually all key stakeholders: teacher education, teacher's union, municipalities and student teachers, as well as researchers, school principals and teachers themselves.

The objectives of the TEDP have been implemented through joint programs of higher education institutions, providing teacher education. In these programs, higher education institutions and education providers have together created development models for the degree programs and the continuing professional development from ECEC to TVET teacher education. The programs have focused in many ways on issues related to ESD and GCED, such as

- Strengthening inclusion and the human rights-based approach in vocational teacher education
- Developing contents for teacher education in Finland related to gender equality, planning and equality work (SetSTOP)
- Linguistically responsive and culturally sustaining pedagogy
- Inter-religious Dialogue and multiliteracy skills
- Creating Spaces for Diversity of Worldviews in Early Childhood Education

Descriptions of some of the programs, Ministry of Education and Culture:

<https://minedu.fi/documents/1410845/4183002/Teacher+Education+Development+Projects+2017.pdf/4d9358f9-4fde-4000-ab02-60b2fd647098/Teacher+Education+Development+Projects+2017.pdf>

The Ministry of Education and Culture appointed a **Teacher education forum** for the term 2016-2018 to support the development of both pre-service and in-service training for teachers. The term of this forum has been continued and is now 2020-2022.

Teachers also take actively part in in-service training, which is provided by a range of actors, funded by the Finnish National Agency for Education EDUFI (ca. 12 million EUR annually). These in-service trainings also take the ESD and GCED themes in many ways into account.

The University of Helsinki has coordinated, in collaboration with the Ministry of Justice and the Human Rights Centre a **project for promoting education for democratic citizenship and human rights education (EDC/HRE) in teacher training** (2018–2021) in association with the UNESCO Chair in Values, Dialogue and Human Rights in Education. Studies have shown that although Finland is in a good position to provide education for democratic citizenship and human rights education, teachers' skills vary significantly in this respect, and their knowledge of the related legal rules is fragmentary. Much depends on the active efforts of individual teachers. Although many have wished that the topics would be discussed in teacher education, no consistent training on education for democratic citizenship and human rights education is currently offered to all teachers. The above mentioned project by the University of Helsinki has – among others – developed a web-based course in education for democratic citizenship and human rights education for teachers: <https://www.helsinki.fi/en/projects/human-rights-democracy-values-and-dialogue-in-education> (see also sections “materials and publications” of the web page)

The Finnish National Agency for Education (EDUFI) and the Human Rights Centre of Finland have jointly constructed a learning module (2017-2018) for educational management and **school leadership on fundamental and human rights in educational sector**. The module (in form of a tour) was carried out in co-operation with the Regional State Administrative Agencies, Trade Union of Education in Finland and Finnish Principals Association, which helped to ensure a good range of heads of schools nationally.

Materials for schools and educators

Based on the continuous collaboration of the Finnish National Agency for Education (EDUFI) with different Ministries, human rights organisations, universities/researchers, civil society actors and other stakeholders, EDUFI continuously publishes and collects materials for schools and teachers, related to many aspects of ESD and GCED.

As a non-exhaustive example, in the area of education for democracy and human rights education, a large selection of materials and resources can be found on the EDUFI web pages (in Finnish): <https://www.oph.fi/fi/opettajat-ja-kasvattajat/ihmisoikeus-ja-demokratiakasvatus>

Other sources of materials and guides:

<https://www.oph.fi/fi/ilmasto-ja-ymparistokasvatus-seka-kiertotalous> (climate responsibility, environmental sustainability)

<https://www.oph.fi/fi/globalikasvatus-ja-kansainvalisyys> (GCED)

Non-discrimination, equity and equality:

<https://www.oph.fi/fi/tilastot-ja-julkaisut/julkaisut/mukana-tasa-arvo-ja-yhdenvertaisuustyo-toisella-asteella>

<https://www.oph.fi/fi/tilastot-ja-julkaisut/julkaisut/tasa-arvotyo-taitolaji>

Against bullying and sexual harassment:

<https://www.oph.fi/fi/tilastot-ja-julkaisut/julkaisut/kiusaamisen-vastainen-tyo-kouluissa-ja-oppilaitoksissa>

<https://www.oph.fi/fi/tilastot-ja-julkaisut/julkaisut/opas-seksuaalisen-hairinnan-ennaltaehkaisemiseksi-ja-siihen>

Holocaust:

<https://www.oph.fi/fi/holokaustin-opetus>

The Finnish National Agency for Education has published a Teacher's Guide (2019) 'BUILDING RESILIENCE – in support of democracy education' <https://www.oph.fi/en/statistics-and-publications/publications/building-resilience-support-democracy-education> and (2017)

'CONSTRUCTIVE INTERACTION - strengthening democratic inclusion, preventing hate speech and violent radicalization'. <https://www.oph.fi/en/statistics-and-publications/publications/constructive-interaction>

In addition to these publications written by Finnish experts, the essential international processes and materials have been translated into Finnish and Swedish, such as:

- Teacher's guide on prevention of violent extremism, UNESCO
- Competences for Democratic Culture Framework, Council of Europe
- Teaching Controversial Issues, Council of Europe
- Managing Controversy, Council of Europe

A set of guidelines by the Finnish National Agency for Education (2018, was distributed to all schools, in order to increase the awareness about the conceptualization and response around PVE: Prevention of Violent Radicalization in Schools and educational institutions (2018): <https://www.oph.fi/english/publications/brochures>

Prevention of violent radicalisation in early childhood education and care (2019): <https://www.oph.fi/en/statistics-and-publications/publications/prevention-violent-radicalisation-early-childhood>

Prevention of violent radicalisation in vocational education (2020, only in Finnish): <https://www.oph.fi/fi/tilastot-ja-julkaisut/julkaisut/vakivaltaisen-radikalisoitumisen-ja-ekstremismin-ennaltaehkaisy>

Guidelines to support constructive interaction / mediation have been published

C1b. Please provide examples of teacher training policies or curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents. If possible, include examples related to initial training and to continuing professional development.

See our reply above.

*C2 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach GCED and ESD during initial or pre-service training and/or through continuing professional development. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Initial or pre-service training				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	9	9
For teachers of other subjects	1	1	9	9
Continuing professional development				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	9	9
For teachers of other subjects	1	1	9	9

*C3 Please indicate on which GCED and ESD themes pre-service or in-service training is available for teachers, trainers and educators at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

*C4 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach the following dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	9	9
Skills	1	1	9	9
Values	1	1	9	9
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	9	9

*C5 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to use the following approaches to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	0
Cross curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment, and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school)	1

D. Student assessment (paras 4 and 5 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

D1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are covered in student assessments and examinations. Indicate whether students are assessed only on their knowledge of and skills related to the topics being tested or also on their values, attitudes and/or behaviours.

In basic education and general upper secondary education, the transversal competences, including GCED and ESD, are assessed in each course or study unit. Values and attitudes are assessed formatively, knowledge and skills summatively. The assessment of knowledge and skills is based on verified demonstrations of how well and to what extent the pupil or the student has attained the objectives set for a course or study unit.

In vocational education, the student's competence is assessed according to the nationally defined vocational competence requirements and assessment criteria. Thus, the assessment focuses on both knowledge, skills, and attitudes.

*D2 Please indicate whether the GCED and ESD themes below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	9	9
2. Gender equality	1	1	9	9
3. Human rights	1	1	9	9
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	9	9
5. Climate change	1	1	9	9
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	9	9
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	9	9
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	9	9

*D3 Please indicate which of the dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	1	9
Skills	1	1	1	9
Values	9	9	9	9
Attitudes and behaviours	9	9	9	9

E. Mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment (paras 4-5, 7, 10-19 and 33-37 of the 1974 Recommendation)

*E1 Based on your responses to questions in the previous four sections (laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment) please indicate to what extent global citizenship education (GCED) and education for sustainable development (ESD) are mainstreamed⁵ in (a) education laws and policies, (b) curricula (c) teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) and (d) student assessment in your country. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell in the table below.

KEY:

0 Not at all

GCED and ESD are not mainstreamed.

1 Partially

Some GCED and/or ESD themes⁶ are mainstreamed. Select this option if GCED is mainstreamed but ESD is not (or vice versa).

2 Extensively

Most GCED and ESD themes are mainstreamed.

9 Not known

It is not known whether GCED and ESD are mainstreamed or not.

99 Not applicable

The given level of government does not have responsibility for the given component (policies, curricula, teacher education or student assessment) and/or does not have responsibility for the given level or type of education. This may occur at the national level in federal countries where education is the responsibility of individual states or at the sub-national level in small countries where there is only one level of government.

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
(a) Education laws and policies	1	1	1	1
(b) Curricula	2	2	2	99
(c) Teacher education	1	1	99	99
(d) Student assessment	9	9	99	99
Sub-national				
(a) Education laws and policies	99	99	99	99
(b) Curricula	2	2	2	99
(c) Teacher education	99	99	99	99
(d) Student assessment	9	9	99	99

F. Technical and vocational education and training (paras 25-29 of the 1974 Recommendation)

F1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in technical and vocational education and training. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

In the Finnish TVET, all vocational qualifications cover ESD and GCED through key competences. VET supports students' development as human beings, members of society and employees for different occupations. Sustainable development is in many ways inserted in the vocational qualification requirements. Vocational education is guided by qualification criteria developed for different fields. The common units of vocational undergraduate degrees ensure a common foundation for all students in general working life skills and general education skills. Sustainable development is one of these common units. In addition, sustainable development is integrated in every qualification requirements as needed in different professions.

⁵ GCED and ESD are mainstreamed if their themes are mentioned explicitly in relevant documents and are expected to be implemented by the relevant authorities (e.g. Ministries, regional or local education authorities), educational institutions (e.g. schools, colleges and universities) and/or education professionals (e.g. teachers, lecturers, trainers and educators) as appropriate.

⁶ Refer to the schema in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

In order to strengthen the sustainability competences or green skills, the Finnish National Agency for Education has started work with the aim of building a clear set of optional courses in TVET. A new optional part, Climate Responsibility, will be added to the requirements in 2021.

The Sustainability Online Studies for Vocational Teachers will be implemented in autumn 2020, spring 2021 and autumn 2021. In the training, VET teachers become acquainted with the dimensions of sustainable development and sustainable future indicators for VET teachers through a tailor-made online course and webinars to support learning. (<https://www.kadenjalki.fi/kestavan-elamantavan-edistajat/>)

G. Adult education (para 30 of the 1974 Recommendation)

- G1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in adult education and other forms of non-formal education including youth education, out-of-school education, etc. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

The question is difficult to answer, due to the autonomous character of liberal adult education. However, due to the very nature of adult liberal education to promote active citizenship, it is fair to say that the education providers also take into account global and sustainability issues, hence the themes of ESD and GCED, when planning and developing the education provided.

According to the legislation (Liberal Adult Education Act 632/1998) the purpose of liberal adult education is to provide education and training that supports people's versatile development, cohesion of society, equality, sustainable development, multiculturalism, internationalization and active citizenship based on the principle of lifelong learning. An essential aspect of liberal adult education is that everyone has the right to apply to take part in it.

Liberal adult education does not provide a degree or qualification, and its content is not governed by legislation. Education providers make all decisions on the objectives and content of the studies.

Liberal adult education providers comprise local authorities, joint municipal authorities, associations, foundations and limited liability companies. Liberal adult education includes both activities based on various sets of values and those that are neutral. The affiliated organisations can represent various world views or religious beliefs or act on the basis of local or regional civic needs. Studies vary from night school to full-time short-term or long-term courses, distance studies and intensive courses.

Liberal adult education institutions offer studies that improve civic skills, social studies, general education studies and studies for hobby-based or interest-based information and skills acquisition. Liberal education institutions offer courses in various subjects and in different crafts.

Adult education emphasizes self-motivated learning, a sense of community, and inclusion.

As part of the government program, the Ministry of Education and Culture has prepared a **parliamentary reform on continuous learning**, which aims at better responding to people's lifelong need for upskilling and reskilling. This comprehensive reform will apply to each point of the educational pathway at which the educational system interfaces with the provision and funding of education, social security, relocation security, unemployment security, independent and labour market training, and recognition of prior learning. Common policy lines were adopted in December 2020.

In terms of ESD/ GCED, the policy lines has an objective to create a service ecosystem for continuous learning. This is understood as a prerequisite for a green transition of the society in a socially, ecologically and economically sustainable way. Different levels and parts of the continuing learning need to work seamlessly together. The objectives also cover the development of foresight, with special emphasis on sectors in rapid transition due to technological development and climate change. The policy gives special emphasis on the most under-represented groups.

Ministry of Education and Culture: https://minedu.fi/-/jatkuvan-oppimisen-uudistukselle-hyvaksyttiin-yhteiset-linjaukset-osaaminen-turvaa-tulevaisuuden?languageId=en_US

H. Research and International Co-operation (paras 41-45 of the 1974 Recommendation)

H1 Please describe what kinds of research or experimentation have been carried out to improve the implementation of GCED and/or ESD. Describe briefly how the results of such activities have influenced education policies, curricula and/or teaching practices.

In Finland, universities and the universities of applied sciences (HEI's) are autonomous, in terms of conducting research and planning the degrees and studies offered.

The HEI's conduct negotiations with the Ministry of Education and Culture at the beginning of every four-year agreement term, in which operational and qualitative targets and the necessary resources are defined. The common targets concerning all HEI's also include sustainable development.

In line with its policy on Sustainable Development (2020), the Ministry of Education and Culture seeks to strengthen the preconditions and resources for research, innovation and development activities through measures in accordance with the RDI roadmap of the Government Programme and by improving the possibilities to support the implementation of the goals of the 2030 Agenda through RDI activities. The Government has set the goal of increasing Finland's expenditure to GDP ratio for research and development from the current 2.7 per cent to 4 per cent by 2030. **The National Roadmap for Research, Development and Innovation:** <https://minedu.fi/en/rdi-roadmap>

In terms of Higher Education, we also wish to add that **research** is inherently international by nature. There are several institutions offering degree programmes in various disciplines, relating to ESD and GCED.

The Ministry for Foreign Affairs provides funding for the **development research** through the Academy of Finland.

The **Higher Education Institutions Institutional Cooperation Instrument (HEI ICI)** supports cooperation projects between higher education institutions in Finland and the developing world that are designed to enhance higher education provision in these countries. The projects support the higher education institutions in developing their subject-specific, methodological, educational and administrative capacities. Finland's Ministry for Foreign Affairs provides funding for the programme through its development cooperation funds. The Finnish National Agency for Education (EDUFI) administers the programme. Currently, a total of nine projects have been granted funding with a total budget of 11,2 MIL euro for 2020-2024. <https://www.oph.fi/en/programmes/hei-ici-programme>

The Ministry of Education and Culture funds the "FinCEAL Plus BRIDGES" project, which supports the development of partnerships and collaborative research activities between the Finnish research community and those in Africa, Asia, and Latin America and the Caribbean (LAC). <https://www.unipid.fi/finceal/what-is-finceal/>

Universities Finland, or UNIFI for short, is a co-operational organisation for Finnish universities. In 2020, it published **12 theses on sustainable development and responsibility**. The theses have been divided under five themes. In addition to the universities' basic tasks (research, teaching and societal interaction), these theses cover (campus) activities and the preconditions for the universities' operations more widely. Theses are intended as drivers of the activities especially for the universities themselves. They also challenge universities to operate more sustainably and responsibly. For example, thesis number 1 states « Research activities are aimed at solving great sustainability challenges » and thesis number 4 states : « Studies in sustainable development are part of all degrees and the continuous learning offered. »

<https://www.unifi.fi/viestit/theses-on-sustainable-development-and-responsibility/>

Likewise, **Arene – the Rectors' Conference of Finnish Universities of Applied Sciences** - has approved a **joint programme for sustainable development and responsibility** based

on the Agenda 2030. The core of the programme consists of strengthening the ecological handprint of universities of applied sciences and reducing their carbon footprint. These ideas have been depicted as 14 promises and concrete measures that will start at the beginning of 2021. The aim is that each graduate has the ability to promote sustainable development and combat the negative impacts of climate change in society. The aim is that sustainability and responsibility will be taken into account in all RDI activities and they are directed towards producing solutions to sustainability challenges, promoting sustainable development and reducing the impacts of climate change. Also in management and personnel matters, universities of applied sciences promise to act as economically, ecologically, culturally and socially responsible employers. Universities of applied sciences will be carbon neutral by 2030. In order to achieve this, universities of applied sciences systematically commit themselves to taking various measures to reduce emissions, to monitor the development of their carbon footprint and to seek other means of achieving carbon neutrality together. The most significant producers of carbon footprint in universities of applied sciences are related to mobility and travel, properties, food services and procurements.

<http://www.arene.fi/ajankohtaista/universities-of-applied-sciences-sustainable-development-skills-for-everyone/>

Finnish University Partnership for International Development – UniPID is a network of Finnish universities to advance universities' global responsibility and to strengthen their response to global challenges. UniPID offers a variety of support services for the interdisciplinary studies, research and societal impact of universities related to global development. The UniPID network was established in response to the Johannesburg Summit on Sustainable Development in 2002. UniPID has been coordinated by the University of Jyväskylä since 2005. The network has been offering virtual studies courses for students at UniPID member universities from 2007 with increasing success. It receives its core funding through member university fees. UniPID currently represents nine Finnish universities.

<https://www.unipid.fi/>

Universities also have their individual approaches. For example, the University of Helsinki published in October 2020 its **Africa programme for 2021–2030**. Global action, sustainability and responsibility are also emphasised in the Strategic Plan of the University of Helsinki 2021–2030.

<https://www.helsinki.fi/en/news/higher-education-science-policy/the-university-of-helsinki-starts-a-new-africa-program-and-a-strategic-partnership-with-the-university-of-nairobi>

Finnish Universities are also active partners with UNESCO. Universities host seven **UNESCO Chairs and one UNITWIN network**. The majority of them are focused on the field of education. The University of Helsinki chairs a platform for dialogue and exchange, where UNESCO Chairs and the UNITWIN network can meet with other stakeholders in Finland, who are active in UNESCO's networks.

- UNESCO Chair on Digital Platforms for Transforming Economies (University of Jyväskylä, since 2018)
- UNESCO Chair in Values, Dialogue and Human Rights in Education (University of Helsinki, since 2017)
- UNESCO Chair on Educational Ecosystems for Equity and Quality of Learning (University of Helsinki, since 2017)
- UNITWIN Network on Teacher Education for Social Justice and Diversity in Education (University of Lapland, since 2017)
- UNESCO Chair in Learning Society and Futures of Education (University of Turku, since 2016)
- UNESCO Chair on Inclusive Literacy Learning for All (University of Jyväskylä, since 2015)
- UNESCO Interdisciplinary Chair for Sustainable Water Services (UNICWAS) (University of Tampere, since 2012) While water is clearly a separate sector – and water services are a part of it – it is also a connector of many sectors in society.
- UNESCO Chair in Global E-Learning with applications to multiple domains (University of Tampere, since 2002)

Funding of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs to advance human rights education has also been provided to Higher Education Institutions, for instance in 2016-2019 the Ministry for Foreign Affairs funded a **cooperation project** between the [Institute for Human Rights](#) at Åbo Akademi University in Finland and [Centre for Human Rights](#) at University of Pretoria in South Africa, [School of Law](#) at Addis Ababa University in Ethiopia, [School of Law](#) at Makerere University in Uganda and [School of Law](#) at University of Nairobi in Kenya. The project **improved capacity in research and research-based teaching in human rights in project countries**. The emphasis was on improving **quality and availability of PhD training in human rights**, and strengthening the role of human rights research in societal development processes.

There are also **scientific associations** with aims to increase multidisciplinary research relating to ESD and GCED. For example, "ETMU" promotes multidisciplinary research on ethnic relations in Finland. Ethnic relations are defined broadly to encompass also research on international migration, refugees, intercultural dialogue, racism, nationalism, immigrant integration, minority rights, immigrants, national minorities, citizenship and other related topics. <http://etmu.fi/en/about/purpose/>

To add, an academic **Global Education Research in Finland (GERIF)** network was formed in 2018, for bringing together researchers working with global education in Finland. The network transmits information about academic events and publications. It also takes part in continuous critical discussions on the position and objectives of global education. Each year, the network organizes events for researchers and practitioners, for instance in connection to the annual Finnish Educational Research Association conference. The network cooperates with the European ANGEL-network (Academic Network for global education and learning). <https://gerif.home.blog/about-gerif/>

H2 Please indicate which types of activities are available that promote international co-operation at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Hosting of international meetings on GCED and/or ESD	9	1	1	9
Participation in international meetings abroad on GCED and/or ESD	9	1	1	9
Support for programmes hosting foreign students, researchers and/or teachers	1	1	1	9
Membership of international networks including ASPnet	1	1	1	9
Joint research projects on GCED and/or ESD with foreign institutions	1	1	1	9
Other activities (please specify):				

I. **Any other comments**

- 11 Please indicate whether your country has faced any constraints, in particular related to global or national crises, including natural disasters, in implementing the 1974 Recommendation during the reporting period.

- 12 Please provide any other relevant information or clarifications regarding the implementation of the 1974 Recommendation or the mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in your country's education system.

We wish to emphasize that our reply is not exhaustive. Due to the broad scope of the 1974 Recommendation, as well as ESD and GCED, an exhaustive report would be virtually impossible to conduct, yet we have aimed at presenting some of the key measures.

In the following, we provide some further practices

In Finland, the teachers, schools and education providers are encouraged to engage in **networks and peer learning**. For example the national UNESCO Associated Schools network, coordinated by the Finnish National Agency of Education, covers 60-70 schools, extending from ECEC to upper secondary level. The UNESCO associated schools, as part of a global network, pilot and share good practices, resources, methods and tools, in terms of promoting the 2030 Agenda on sustainable development and global citizenship, also through human rights education. The national network collaborates with the related UNESCO Chairs in Finland, including with Prof. Arto Kallioniemi, **UNESCO Chair in Values, Dialogue and Human Rights in Education** at the University of Helsinki.

Over the past 25 years, Finland has been financing **schools' and municipalities' international activities with states subsidies**. A large part of the financed projects is geared towards promoting GCED and ESD. The Finnish National Agency for Education, as the agency responsible for administrating these funds, pays special attention to the elements in such projects that help implement and further develop the GCED and ESD approaches in the curricula. While doing so, such projects are favored that are carried out in the form of **Internationalization at Home**, i.e. in ways that provide equal access to all students as no travelling abroad is involved.

The **Ministry of Environment** (through the Centre for Economic Development, Transport and the Environment in Central Finland) provides annual support to Finnish CSOs for projects on ESD. These projects are usually regional in scope with an emphasis on environmental sustainability issues, categorized as non-formal and informal education reaching a broad public from children to adults, depending on the project.

One of the civil society organisations receiving support from the **Ministry for Foreign Affairs** is "**Fingo**", **Finnish civil society's expert organisation on development policy issues**. Among others, Fingo coordinates a **global education network comprising over 100 organizations**, most of which collaborate with schools, but many also operate more broadly in the field of lifelong learning and teacher education. Fingo disseminates learning materials, tools and good practices, suitable also for human rights education, freely available for educators. In Finland, CSO's collaborate actively with schools. <http://www.gloaalikasvatus.fi/node/930>. Fingo has also played an important part in establishing the **Bridge47 network**, which mobilises civil society from around the world to contribute to the implementation of SDG target 4.7 (covers both GCED and ESD).

Civil society actors are important in promoting ESD and GCED. The thematic expertise as well as the pedagogical support, methods and tools that CSOs are providing for teachers, educators, and active citizens, are important in mainstreaming ESD and GCED in the society. Research shows

that there is a correlation between countries that do have a strong non-formal education sector working on ESD/GCE and the integration of ESD/GCE in national curricula (indicator 4.7.1b).

Finland is also active in international networks. For example, Finland has contributed in the development of the **Council of Europe's Reference Framework of Competences for Democratic Culture (RFCDC)**, which was among the priorities of Finland's Presidency in the CoE Committee of Ministers in spring 2019. The aims and principles of the Reference Framework promote human rights education in many ways.

The RFCDC Framework, Vol. 1 by the Council of Europe has been translated in Finnish in 2020. The original can be downloaded at <https://www.coe.int/en/web/reference-framework-of-competences-for-democratic-culture/rfcdc>

Additionally, the implementation of the RFCDC has been promoted among Finnish schools through the CoE Free to Speak – safe to learn – Democratic Schools for All -campaign. The campaign's pages are at <https://www.coe.int/en/web/campaign-free-to-speak-safe-to-learn>

Parallel to the democracy framework, and even prior to that, Finland has taken on board the Council of Europe conventions and recommendations concerning promotion of people's linguistic rights: here the protection of **linguistic diversity** as part of the invaluable human heritage has been given a central role, but also the promotion of **linguistically and culturally responsive pedagogies** which are seen as key tools to help boost the participation, learning and agency of all students, especially those with immigrant backgrounds.

Finland actively participates in the **Global Education Network Europe (GENE)**. Over the past years, GENE has inspired not only the ways in which GCED has been elaborated in the core curricula, but also provided an incentive for active cross-ministerial cooperation (Ministry for Foreign Affairs, MoE, EDUFI) to discuss and develop global education policies and funding in Finland.

As a member of **IHRA** (International Holocaust Remembrance Alliance) Finland participates actively in IHRA Plenary meetings and has a permanently acting Finnish National IHRA-committee with cross-ministerial cooperation (Ministry for Foreign Affairs, MoE, EDUFI), University-researchers, National Advisory Board of Roma affairs, Peace Building Institute and the Jewish community of Helsinki. The Recommendations for Teaching and Learning about the Holocaust (2019) by IHRA and UNESCO, have recently been translated in Finnish, by the Finnish National Agency for Education:

<https://holocaustremembrance.com/resources/educational-materials/ihra-recommendations-teaching-and-learning-about-holocaust>

The **Ministry for Foreign Affairs provides support to Finnish CSOs** to carry out projects related to [global citizenship education and development communication](#) to Finnish audiences, including in primary, secondary and higher education, vocational education and training, and the broader public through non-formal and informal education (including museums and film festivals). Human rights are visible in this funding instrument in at least three ways. First, according to [Finland's Guidance Note on the Human Rights-Based Approach in Development Cooperation](#), all funded projects must be at least human rights sensitive, and indeed many projects have human rights norms and principles at the centre of their analysis and objectives. Second, human rights are the topic of many projects, as they range from global challenges such as food security and the human rights of migrants to combatting racism and extremism in Finland. Third, the funding instrument includes since 2018 a thematic category on business' responsibility to respect human rights. In projects of this category, CSOs work mainly with Finnish companies with global supply chains, training them on the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights and measuring their compliance according to international standards.

The MFA's support to Finnish CSO's includes support related to development communication and communication related to sustainable development. As Finland's development policy is human rights-based, the support focuses on providing CSOs with the possibility to **conduct training on human rights issues to media professionals and journalists**, among other target groups.

Projects that have targeted media professionals and journalists that have been carried out by CSOs, have focused on, inter alia, media literacy, women's rights and gender equality, including sexual and reproductive health and rights.

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